

# DSAT Reading & Writing — Quotation Illustrates Claim — SOLUTIONS

20 Original Practice Questions | Easy · Medium · Hard

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## Q1. [Easy]

**Correct Answer: A**

**REASONING:** The claim is that Mr. Karim expresses affection through practical acts rather than words.

Option A shows him polishing shoes (practical act) instead of saying 'I love you' (words)—a direct illustration of the claim.

### WHY EACH WRONG OPTION IS WRONG:

B) Cooking skills and gardening are not presented as expressions of affection toward the niece.

C) This shows verbal affection, which contradicts the claim that he expresses love through actions, not words.

D) Traveling away does not illustrate affection through practical acts.

**TRAP ALERT:** Option C is the most tempting wrong answer because it IS about affection—but it's verbal affection, which contradicts 'through practical acts rather than words.'

**KEY INSIGHT:** Match BOTH parts of the claim: (1) practical acts + (2) not words. The correct quotation must show both.

**FAST METHOD:** The claim has a contrast (acts vs. words). Look for a quote that shows acts AND the absence of words.

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## Q2. [Easy]

**Correct Answer: C**

**REASONING:** The claim is that residents resist change. Option C shows the town council voting down a road improvement because the old road 'had served them fine for a hundred years,' directly illustrating resistance to change.

### WHY EACH WRONG OPTION IS WRONG:

A) This describes eagerness to adopt new technology—the opposite of resisting change.

B) A festival attracting visitors describes tourism, not resistance to change.

D) Lobbying for infrastructure funding shows openness to change, not resistance.

**TRAP ALERT:** Option A directly contradicts the claim. On quotation questions, always check whether a quote shows the OPPOSITE of the claim.

**KEY INSIGHT:** The correct quotation should show the claim in action. Resistance to change = rejecting a proposed improvement.

**FAST METHOD:** Claim: resist change. Look for a quote where someone rejects or opposes a new development → C.

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### Q3. [Easy]

**Correct Answer: D**

**REASONING:** The claim is that the grandmother treated cooking as storytelling. Option D shows each dish carrying a narrative—the lamb stew has an origin story, the honey cake commemorates an event, the bread matches a village rhythm.

**WHY EACH WRONG OPTION IS WRONG:**

- A) Scientific precision is about measurement, not storytelling.
- B) Rarely cooking does not illustrate treating cooking as storytelling.
- C) A tidy kitchen is about organization, not narrative.

**TRAP ALERT:** Option A might seem related to cooking skill, but 'scientific precision' is the opposite of storytelling. Precision ≠ narrative.

**KEY INSIGHT:** The correct quote must demonstrate the specific connection between cooking and narrative, not just cooking skill.

**FAST METHOD:** Claim: cooking = storytelling. Look for a quote where dishes carry stories → D.

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### Q4. [Easy]

**Correct Answer: A**

**REASONING:** The claim presents a contrast: Elena is cautious, Luz is impulsive. Option A shows Elena deliberating for twenty minutes and choosing the same dish (cautious), while Luz points randomly and calls it 'destiny' (impulsive).

**WHY EACH WRONG OPTION IS WRONG:**

- B) Both sisters reading novels shows similarity, not contrast.
- C) Elena seeking Luz's advice shows respect, not the cautious/impulsive contrast.
- D) This describes Luz as careful—the opposite of impulsive.

**TRAP ALERT:** Option D reverses Luz's characterization. The claim says Luz is impulsive, but this quote describes careful budgeting and research.

**KEY INSIGHT:** When the claim involves a contrast between two characters, the correct quote must show BOTH sides of the contrast.

**FAST METHOD:** Contrast claim: cautious vs. impulsive. Only B shows both traits in action.

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**Q5. [Easy]**

**Correct Answer: D**

**REASONING:** The claim is that the station inspires a sense of abandonment. Option D shows weeds through cracked tiles and dust-covered glass—physical details conveying neglect and disuse.

**WHY EACH WRONG OPTION IS WRONG:**

- A) A recently renovated station is the opposite of abandoned.
- B) Crowded platforms indicate active use, not abandonment.
- C) A popular meeting point suggests vitality, not abandonment.

**TRAP ALERT:** Options A, B, and D all depict an active, functioning station—the opposite of the claim. Eliminate contradictions first.

**KEY INSIGHT:** For setting-based claims, the correct quotation will use sensory details (visual, auditory) that evoke the claimed atmosphere.

**FAST METHOD:** Claim: abandonment. Look for decay imagery (weeds, cracks, dust) → D.

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**Q6. [Easy]**

**Correct Answer: B**

**REASONING:** The claim is that Devika has an exceptional memory. Option B shows her recalling names, notebook colors, and roll-call order from every school term—a vivid demonstration of extraordinary recall.

**WHY EACH WRONG OPTION IS WRONG:**

- A) Creative problem-solving and motivating colleagues are leadership skills, not memory feats.
- C) Forgetting where she parked directly contradicts the claim of exceptional memory.
- D) Preferring fiction is a reading preference, not evidence of memory.

**TRAP ALERT:** Option C is a trap that contradicts the claim. Always check that the quote supports, not undermines, the stated trait.

**KEY INSIGHT:** Exceptional memory must be shown through specific, concrete acts of remembering. General intelligence or personality traits do not suffice.

**FAST METHOD:** Claim: exceptional memory. Which quote shows someone remembering unusual amounts of detail? → B.

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**Q7. [Medium]**

**Correct Answer: C**

**REASONING:** The claim is that Henrik uses humor as a shield to avoid discussing emotions. Option C shows him deflecting an emotional question ('how he was really feeling') with a joke ('Fantastic, like a house on fire') during a painful time (divorce week). This directly shows humor as emotional avoidance.

**WHY EACH WRONG OPTION IS WRONG:**

- A) Laughing at others' jokes but not making his own does not show using humor as a shield.
- B) A serious demeanor contradicts the claim that he uses humor.
- D) Openly sharing struggles is the opposite of using humor to avoid emotions.

**TRAP ALERT:** Option A is tricky: it mentions laughing but does not show Henrik using HIS OWN humor to deflect emotional questions.

**KEY INSIGHT:** The claim has two parts: (1) uses humor + (2) to avoid discussing emotions. The quote must show both: humor AND emotional avoidance.

**FAST METHOD:** Look for: emotional question → humorous deflection. That pattern appears only in B.

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**Q8. [Medium]**

**Correct Answer: B**

**REASONING:** The claim is that Nneka's authority comes from community trust, not her title. Option B explicitly states the villagers obeyed her 'not because she could compel them' (no formal power) but because 'her counsel had never steered them wrong' (earned trust).

**WHY EACH WRONG OPTION IS WRONG:**

- A) This describes authority from official rank and strict penalties—formal power, not trust.
- C) Being appointed by a governor describes top-down authority, not community trust.
- D) Rarely attending meetings and sending written decisions does not illustrate trust-based authority.

**TRAP ALERT:** Option A directly contradicts the claim by describing exactly the kind of authority the claim says Nneka does NOT have.

**KEY INSIGHT:** When a claim describes authority as coming from one source (trust) rather than another (title), the correct quote must show the first source AND the absence of the second.

**FAST METHOD:** Claim: trust, not title. Look for a quote that explicitly names both: 'not because she could compel them... but because her counsel...' → B.

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**Q9. [Medium]**

**Correct Answer: A**

**REASONING:** The claim is that Dr. Linden views fieldwork as 'almost spiritual.' Option A describes counting seedlings as 'a kind of prayer' and data points as 'an offering to a truth larger than herself'—language explicitly framing science as spiritual practice.

**WHY EACH WRONG OPTION IS WRONG:**

- B) Meticulous record-keeping shows professionalism, not spiritual practice.
- C) Publishing and presenting at conferences shows academic success, not spirituality.
- D) Complaining about exhaustion contradicts viewing fieldwork as spiritual.

**TRAP ALERT:** Option B describes precision but not reverence. Scientific rigor and spiritual feeling are different things.

**KEY INSIGHT:** Spiritual language includes words like 'prayer,' 'offering,' 'sacred,' 'reverence.' The correct quote must use such language or its equivalent.

**FAST METHOD:** Claim: fieldwork = spiritual. Scan for spiritual vocabulary → 'prayer,' 'offering' in B.

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**Q10. [Medium]**

**Correct Answer: B**

**REASONING:** The claim is that the father believed education was the only reliable form of wealth. Option B shows him saying that possessions ('house and land') can be taken away, but knowledge ('what is in here') cannot—directly equating education with secure wealth.

**WHY EACH WRONG OPTION IS WRONG:**

- A) Investing in real estate shows belief in property, not education, as wealth.
- C) Rarely offering advice does not illustrate any belief about education.
- D) Valuing practical trades over academic study contradicts the claim about education as wealth.

**TRAP ALERT:** Option D reverses the claim: it shows the father valuing trades OVER education, the opposite of what's stated.

**KEY INSIGHT:** The claim is about education being THE ONLY reliable wealth. The correct quote must show education compared favorably to other forms of wealth.

**FAST METHOD:** Claim: education = only reliable wealth. Look for a quote that contrasts education with material possessions → B (house/land vs. what's in your head).

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**Q11. [Medium]**

**Correct Answer: C**

**REASONING:** The claim is that the economy depends entirely on the unpredictable fishing season. Option C shows the town swinging between prosperity (good catch: new boats, paid debts, late pub hours) and hardship (lean years: empty docks, dark storefronts)—directly illustrating economic dependence on fishing.

**WHY EACH WRONG OPTION IS WRONG:**

- A) A diversified economy contradicts 'depends entirely' on fishing.
- B) Being a commuter town implies dependence on nearby cities, not on fishing.
- D) Petitioning for a factory suggests awareness of the problem but does not illustrate the dependence itself.

**TRAP ALERT:** Option A directly contradicts the claim by describing diversification away from fishing dependence.

**KEY INSIGHT:** When a claim says 'depends entirely on X,' the correct quote must show that when X changes, everything changes.

**FAST METHOD:** Claim: economy depends on fishing. Look for economic fluctuation tied to catch quality → C.

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**Q12. [Medium]**

**Correct Answer: C**

**REASONING:** The claim is that Astrid finds conversation exhausting and solitude not. Option C directly contrasts: an hour with visitors = mental marathon; a full day alone = no fatigue.

**WHY EACH WRONG OPTION IS WRONG:**

- A) Hosting dinner parties suggests she enjoys social interaction.
- B) Loneliness driving her to leave suggests she finds solitude painful, not restful.
- D) Being known for warmth and sociability contradicts the claim.

**TRAP ALERT:** Option B reverses the claim: it says solitude causes loneliness, whereas the claim says solitude is NOT exhausting (implying she tolerates or prefers it).

**KEY INSIGHT:** Contrast claims (X is exhausting, Y is not) need quotes that show BOTH sides: the exhaustion from X AND the comfort of Y.

**FAST METHOD:** Claim: conversation = exhausting, solitude = not. Look for a quote comparing both → C.

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**Q13. [Medium]**

**Correct Answer: B**

**REASONING:** The claim is that Augusto sees silence as a survival strategy, not consent. Option B shows him telling his son they hold their tongues because 'the price of speech is one we cannot afford to pay'—framing silence as a calculated response to danger, i.e., survival.

**WHY EACH WRONG OPTION IS WRONG:**

- A) Speaking freely at meetings shows Augusto using speech, not silence.
- C) Believing silence = agreement contradicts the claim that he sees it as something other than consent.
- D) Leaving the city is an action (not silence) and suggests he seeks freedom of speech elsewhere.

**TRAP ALERT:** Option C presents the OLD view the claim says Augusto has moved beyond. He no longer sees silence as consent.

**KEY INSIGHT:** When a claim describes an evolved understanding ('has come to see X not as A but as B'), the correct quote must show the new view (B), not the old one (A).

**FAST METHOD:** New view: silence = survival. Look for a quote framing silence as protective → 'the price of speech' in C.

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**Q14. [Hard]**

**Correct Answer: A**

**REASONING:** The claim is that the maps are 'acts of defiance' against the forces threatening the landscapes. Option A describes each contour line as 'a refusal' and 'a declaration' that the landscape existed and cannot be erased by a developer—explicitly framing mapmaking as defiance.

**WHY EACH WRONG OPTION IS WRONG:**

- B) Drawing maps on commission for the development authority shows cooperation, not defiance.
- C) Preferring digital software addresses tools, not defiance.
- D) Beautiful but inaccurate maps suggest artistry, not defiance.

**TRAP ALERT:** Option B shows the exact opposite of defiance: working FOR the developers. Always check whether a quote aligns or contradicts.

**KEY INSIGHT:** Defiance language includes words like 'refusal,' 'declaration,' 'resistance.' Scan for this vocabulary.

**FAST METHOD:** Claim: maps = defiance. Look for 'refusal,' 'declaration' → A.

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### Q15. [Hard]

**Correct Answer: B**

**REASONING:** The claim is that Nkechi's wisdom lies in asking questions that force reconsideration, not in offering solutions. Option B shows her responding to a demand not with a yes or no but with a question ('What happened to the last canal?') that silences the room by making people confront a failed precedent.

**WHY EACH WRONG OPTION IS WRONG:**

- A) Issuing immediate decisions shows directive authority, not questioning wisdom.
- C) Eloquent speeches are about speaking, not asking questions.
- D) Deferring to the youngest describes deference, not wisdom through questioning.

**TRAP ALERT:** Option A directly contradicts the claim: Nkechi issues decisions rather than asking questions.

**KEY INSIGHT:** The claim specifies a **METHOD** of wisdom (questions, not solutions). The correct quote must show a question that prompts reconsideration.

**FAST METHOD:** Claim: wisdom = asking questions. Look for a question that changes the room's perspective → B.

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### Q16. [Hard]

**Correct Answer: A**

**REASONING:** The claim is that loss is not a single event but ongoing gradual erosion. Option A describes the tide's 'long habit of return, each visit carrying a little more'—repeated small losses over time, exactly matching the concept of gradual erosion.

**WHY EACH WRONG OPTION IS WRONG:**

- B) A single violent storm represents sudden, total loss—the opposite of gradual erosion.
- C) Collecting polished stones describes a peaceful activity, not loss.
- D) Rebuilding after a hurricane describes recovery, not loss.

**TRAP ALERT:** Option B is the classic trap: it describes loss but as a single dramatic event, which is exactly what the claim says loss is NOT.

**KEY INSIGHT:** When a claim defines something by what it IS and what it is NOT ('not a single event but gradual'), the correct quote must match the IS side.

**FAST METHOD:** Claim: gradual erosion, not single event. Option B = single event (eliminate). Option A = repeated small losses (match).

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### Q17. [Hard]

**Correct Answer: D**

**REASONING:** The claim is that the grandmother communicates disapproval through deliberate, pointed silence. Option D shows her responding to Amara's announcement with an exaggeratedly careful silence—setting down the teacup, folding her hands, looking away—'a silence so deliberate it was louder than any rebuke.'

#### **WHY EACH WRONG OPTION IS WRONG:**

- A) Scolding loudly is verbal disapproval, not silent disapproval.
- B) Warm praise for every achievement shows approval, not disapproval.
- C) Expressing opinions freely contradicts communicating through silence.

**TRAP ALERT:** *Option A is the most obvious mismatch: loud verbal scolding is the opposite of pointed silence.*

**KEY INSIGHT:** *Deliberate silence must be shown as intentional and communicative. Random silence (e.g., being quiet because uninterested) would not suffice.*

**FAST METHOD:** *Claim: deliberate silence = disapproval. Look for a scene where silence is conspicuously intentional → D.*

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### Q18. [Hard]

**Correct Answer: D**

**REASONING:** The claim is that Valentina believes creative value lies in the process, not in whether the work is used. Option D has her saying 'A drawing that solves a problem is a drawing that matters, even if the building is never built. The thinking is the thing—the rest is just weather.'

#### **WHY EACH WRONG OPTION IS WRONG:**

- A) Counting completed projects as trophies values results (built buildings), not process.
- B) Abandoning uncommissioned work values external validation, not process.
- C) Completing projects on time describes efficiency, not a philosophy of process over product.

**TRAP ALERT:** *Option A directly contradicts the claim: measuring success by completed buildings = valuing product over process.*

**KEY INSIGHT:** *Process-over-product claims need quotes that explicitly say the work matters regardless of the outcome. Look for 'even if' or 'whether or not' constructions.*

**FAST METHOD:** *Claim: value = process, not use. Look for 'even if the building is never built' → D.*

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### Q19. [Hard]

**Correct Answer: C**

**REASONING:** The claim is that memory reshapes the past to reflect present needs. Option C shows the speaker admitting she has 'rearranged the furniture, softened the light, removed the argument... and replaced it with laughter, because that is the kitchen I need to have come from'—explicitly describing memory as selective reconstruction.

#### **WHY EACH WRONG OPTION IS WRONG:**

- A) 'Photographic precision' suggests faithful preservation, the opposite of reshaping.
- B) Keeping a detailed journal aims to prevent alteration, contradicting the claim.
- D) Identical recall between siblings suggests reliable memory, not reshaping.

**TRAP ALERT:** Option A is the strongest trap: it describes perfect memory, which is exactly what the claim says memory is NOT.

**KEY INSIGHT:** Claims about memory being unreliable need quotes that show the *PROCESS* of distortion, not just the fact of forgetting.

**FAST METHOD:** Claim: memory reshapes past. Look for a quote where the speaker acknowledges altering memories → 'I have rearranged' in B.

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### Q20. [Hard]

**Correct Answer: D**

**REASONING:** The claim is that the tailor sees his craft as imposing order on the chaos of human life. Option D shows him describing clients' disordered lives ('marriages failing, children ungrateful, businesses collapsing') and then saying he can make 'a seam that is straight, a hem that is even'—'And for the hour they wear my coat, the world fits.'

#### **WHY EACH WRONG OPTION IS WRONG:**

- A) Using mass-produced fabrics is about materials, not about imposing order on life's chaos.
- B) Disliking his profession contradicts the idea that he finds meaning in it.
- C) Shrewd pricing describes business sense, not the philosophical view of craft as order.

**TRAP ALERT:** Option A seems related to control (mass-produced = predictable), but it is about fabric choice, not about the tailor's philosophical relationship between craft and chaos.

**KEY INSIGHT:** The claim links two domains: (1) human chaos and (2) craft as order. The correct quote must bridge both domains.

**FAST METHOD:** Claim: craft = order imposed on chaos. Look for a quote that names the chaos AND the order → D (failing marriages + straight seams).

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## TOPIC SUMMARY

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### Top 3 Mistakes:

- Choosing a quotation that relates to the general topic but does not illustrate the SPECIFIC claim made in the passage.
- Selecting a quotation that contradicts the claim (e.g., showing verbal affection when the claim is about non-verbal affection).
- Picking a quotation that illustrates only PART of the claim when the claim has two components (e.g., a contrast between two traits).

### Top 3 Rules:

- Break the claim into its key components and check that the quotation addresses ALL of them.
- Eliminate quotations that contradict any part of the claim—these are common traps.
- The correct quotation shows the claim IN ACTION through specific detail, not through vague or general description.

**Expected Frequency per Module:** 1–2 Quotation Illustrates Claim questions per module (appears in both Module 1 and Module 2, often Easy-to-Medium).